

LEARNING BY CHILDREN WITH SPECIAL NEEDS



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8.1 INTRODUCTION

This unit talks about facilitating the learning of children with special needs and their learning abilities, and also to teach in an inclusive classroom keeping in mind the children with special needs so that they can develop in all aspects along with other children. We will learn about the 21 types of disabilities mentioned in the RPwD Act. We will also understand how to assess these children from time to time by teachers in schools and how to deal with the challenges that arise during assessment. We will also explore how to improve the teaching-learning of these special-needs children through IEP and differentiated learning. With this, the aim is to strengthen the teachers in order to have complete knowledge about how they can make the future of children bright by preparing according to their needs. This will also help in generating confidence among the special-needs children and bring them into the mainstream.

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**8.2 LEARNING OUTCOMES**

After completion of this chapter, the learner:

- defines the term Inclusive Settings;
- comprehends about different learning styles;
- designs differentiated learning practices;
- identifies types and strategies for early interventions in learning disabilities;
- screens early identification of children with learning disabilities;
- comprehends the concept of IEP and use them during teaching learning process.

8.3 INCLUSIVE CLASSROOMS**8.3.1 The Learner**

Since ancient times, human beings have always been associated with the process of learning for their development. In the Vedic period, education was determined for people according to their interest and ability. Education has always been one of the main activities in all the activities of human life. In the present times, people are continuously learning to make their life better. As we know, India is a country of diversity. Here people of different languages, regions, and religions live together. Not only this, diversity can also be seen in learning abilities of our children. As a teacher, we encounter children in school who are unable to follow the guidelines and information. These are called Children with Special Needs (CWSN). There are some children who are unable to learn like other children due to disturbance in one or more senses. Usually, these shortcomings in Divyang children always come with a blessing. It has been seen that decline in one sense is often compensated by the effective working of other senses. If these children are identified in time and given appropriate intervention, they can develop in an all-round way like other children. Here we will discuss main abilities exhibited by these children which they have acquired. These disabilities are as follows:

Table 8.1: List of Disability and their Ability

Physical Disability	Locomotor (Leprosy cured, Cerebral palsy, Dwarfism, Muscular Dystrophy, Acid attack victims)	A locomotor disabled child has limitations in movement, affecting their ability to walk, run, or manipulate objects but IQ is normal. They are ready to all mental activity and best performer to all school indoor activity. Teachers motivate and guide students and their parents for a better future and his/her life.
	Hearing impairment (Hard of hearing, Deaf & Dumb)	Hearing loss or inability to hear properly greatly affects a child's development. Many children have slow speech, language, social skills and academic performance due to this. But if intervention and support are provided at the right time, these children can be trained to utilize their full potential and become successful individuals. The children with hearing loss are not affected by external noise, due to which their ability to pay attention is higher than other children.
	Visual Impairment (Visual Impairment, Low Vision)	Children with visual impairment are born with unique strengths, including enhanced abilities in other senses such as hearing and touch. They can also learn to navigate and interact with the world using Braille, different digital tools, auditory signals, and physical aids etc. Teachers should explain as much as possible the topic they are teaching in their classrooms, speak clearly and make slight changes in the teaching material to make their lessons more interesting. Give children the opportunity to participate in all activities and motivate them.

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	Speech and Language Disability	A child with speech and language disabilities has difficulty in various aspects of communication, expressing their thoughts and ideas in the classroom, understanding spoken or written language, and using language in social contexts. These difficulties can manifest in various ways, such as pronunciation, vocabulary, grammar, sentence construction, and struggles with understanding of complex language. Teachers should focus more on these children's other abilities such as visual-spatial skills, mathematical abilities, or music. However, despite these challenges, children with speech and language disabilities can still develop their unique strengths and abilities.
Intellectual Disability	Specific learning Disability Autism Spectrum Disorder	Learning disabilities affect a child's ability to process and learn information, especially academic and social skills. While intelligence is not affected, children may struggle with reading, writing, math, comprehension and other learning processes. Teachers need to provide timely input and practice to improve reading, writing and math comprehension. This practice can reduce challenges ranging from mild to severe.
Mental Illness		
Multiple Disability		

Disability are mostly caused by :

1. **Chronic Neurological Conditions** : Multiple sclerosis, Parkinson's Disease
2. **Blood Disorder** : Hemophilia, thalassemia, Sickle Cell Disease.

8.3.2 Concept of Inclusive Settings

Inclusive settings refer to an environment that is welcoming and conducive to individuals from all backgrounds, regardless of their differences, whether they are linguistic, regional, socioeconomic status or disability. They aim to create a place where everyone feels valued, respected and has equal opportunities to participate and thrive in any activity. In education, this means integrating students with different needs and learning styles into the same classroom, while providing the necessary support and adjustments.

Key aspects of inclusive settings:

Acceptance: An inclusive setting ensures that all children are accepted as they are by their teachers, parents and other stakeholders.

Respect for diversity: Inclusive settings recognise and cater to the unique qualities, experiences and needs of all individuals.

Equal opportunity: All members have an equal opportunity to participate, learn and contribute, regardless of their background or ability.

Different teaching methods and strategies: In inclusive settings, teachers use a variety of teaching methods such as differentiated instruction, UDL, multi-sensory approach, peer tutoring, assistive technology and other methods to enhance children's abilities for all children with special needs.

8.3.3 Segregation, Integration and Inclusion

Not just India, but across the world, these terms – segregation, integration and inclusion find place in the government documents and scholarly publications. This has been practiced since earlier times when we talk about inclusion. After the 1994, Salamanca Conference the movement of inclusion in countries has intensified so that we can promote inclusion in its true spirit. Here we will understand the difference between these three concepts:

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Table 8.2: Difference between Segregation, Integration, and Inclusion

Segregation	Integration	Inclusion
● focusing on services; ● Establishing a medical model of disability; ● Categorization; ● Providing special treatment; ● Emphasizing the importance of a special setting; categorizing ● Difference; atomizing the individual; ● Stress on inputs; ● Separate curriculum; ● Professional involvement; ● Providing educational opportunities for disabled pupils.	● focusing on needs; ● Perpetuating a medical model of disability; ● Individual adaptation; ● Providing equal treatment; ● Emphasizing benefits to the disabled person; ● Managing difference; ● Atomizing the system; ● Stress on process; ● Focus on curriculum delivery; ● Professionals for inclusion; ● Improving educational opportunities for the pupils who are disabled.	● focusing on rights; ● Positing a social model of disability; ● Institutional adaptation; ● Providing Support for All; ● Emphasizing benefits to all pupils; ● Celebrating diversity; ● Unifying the system; ● Stress on outcomes; ● Focus on curriculum content; ● Professionals and parents in partnership; ● Parents for Inclusion; ● Focusing on school effectiveness and improvement.

8.3.4 Children with Special Needs & Children with Disabilities (CWSN & CwD):

Children with Special Needs: Children with special needs refer to children who suffer from some kind of obstacle in physical, sensory, developmental, behavioural problems or cognitive development. Due to these obstacles, they need more effort and help than normal children. Because their needs are different, the teacher must prepare the parents according to those needs so that they can work for better development of the children. For example, children

with autism, Attention Deficit and Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD), Down syndrome or learning difficulties.

Children with special needs are categorized as follows:

Physical Disability: These children may have difficulty in walking, seeing, hearing, speaking or doing any other physical activity.

Intellectual Disability: These children have a hindrance in intellectual development. They may experience difficulty in learning, understanding or problem solving.

Cognitive Disability: These children have difficulty in learning, paying attention, remembering or other cognitive functions.

Children with Disabilities (CwDs): CwD refer to people who have a long-term condition from birth or thereafter that affects their activities of daily life and who have difficulty performing certain individual and collective activities. For example, people with physical disabilities, visual or hearing impairments, or mental illness. Sometimes this long-term condition affects the entire life.

8.3.5 Impairment, Disability, Handicap

Impairment: Impairment is a physical, psychological, or anatomical abnormality or loss of function in a person's body or its systems, often at the organ level. This can prevent them from performing their regular duties and includes disturbances in bodily structures, organs, and overall function. The International Classification of Impairment, Disability and Handicaps (ICIDH) defines it as a disturbance at the organ or tissue level.

Disability: Impairment means when a person is unable to perform his/her duties due to a serious injury to a body part or due to other causes. Disability is defined as any restriction or reduction of ability (due to impairment) in performing an activity in the manner or extent considered normal for an individual. Limitation/impairment of functional performance and activities. Disturbance at the individual level.

Handicap: According to ICIDH, handicapped is the result of an impairment or disability that limits or prevents the fulfillment of one or more roles considered normal depending on age, sex and socio-cultural factors. Disadvantages resulting from the impairment or disability. Situation-specific limitations.

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8.3.6 Categorization of CWSN (Divyangjan) according to RPWD Act 2016:

National Education Policy 2020 (pg. no.24) stated that social justice and equality can be guaranteed only through education. To ensure equal opportunities to all citizens, inclusive and equitable education is an essential goal in its own right. By reaching out to all the children and in order to tap the immense human resource, the education system must aim to provide opportunities to learn and excel despite the circumstances of one's birth or background. This Policy reaffirms bridging the social gaps in access, participation, and learning outcome.

As per RPWD act 2016, 21 types of disability are given in the list herewith:

Table 8.3: Types of Disabilities as per RPWD Act 2016

Types of Disability			
1	Blindness	16	Sickle Cell Disease
2	Low Vision	17	Hemophilia
3	Hearing Impairment: Deaf and hard of hearing	18	Leprosy Cured Persons
4	Locomotor Disability	19	Parkinson's Disease
5	Dwarfism	20	Acid Attack Victims
6	Cerebral Palsy	21	Multiple Disabilities
7	Intellectual Disability		
8	Autism Spectrum Disorder		
9	Mental Illness		
10	Chronic Neurological Conditions		
11	Muscular Dystrophy		
12	Multiple Sclerosis		
13	Specific Learning Disabilities		
14	Thalassemia		
15	Speech and Language Disability		

8.4 LEARNING DISABILITY AND ABILITIES**8.4.1 Meaning and Definition of Learning Disability**

Learning disabilities are neuro-developmental disorders that significantly inhibit a person's ability to learn new things. As a result, the person or child has difficulty speaking, reading, writing, paying attention, understanding information, remembering and using it when needed, doing mathematical calculations, or coordination between objects and eyes.

According to RPWD Act 2026 “specific learning disabilities means a heterogeneous group of conditions wherein there is a deficit in processing language, spoken or written, that may manifest itself as a difficulty to comprehend, speak, read, write, spell, or to do mathematical calculations and includes such conditions as perceptual disabilities, dyslexia, dysgraphia, dyscalculia, dyspraxia and developmental aphasia.”

In 2013, the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorder, Edition fifth (DSM-5) changed the diagnostic criteria for Specific Learning Disorder (SLD) to combine all three learning disorders (reading, mathematics, and written expression) into one overarching diagnosis. Specific learning disorders (often referred to as a learning disorder or learning disability; see note on terminology) are neurodevelopmental disorders that are typically diagnosed in early school-aged children, although may not be recognised until adulthood. They are characterized by a persistent impairment in at least one of three major areas: reading, written expression, and/or math.

8.4.2 Types of Learning Disability

There are five types of learning disability as given below:

1. Dyslexia

A language processing disorder that affects the ability to read and comprehend is known as dyslexia. Dyslexic children often misread, skip, or substitute words while reading. For example, they may:

- Read ‘was’ as ‘saw’ (letter reversal)
- Read ‘from’ as ‘form’ (letter transposition)
- Read ‘pat’ as ‘tap’ (reversal of sounds)
- Read ‘b’ as ‘d’, or ‘p’ as ‘q’ (letter reversal)
- Omit small words such as ‘is’, ‘of’, or ‘the’ while reading a passage
- Struggle with longer words, e.g., reading ‘elephant’ as ‘elpant’ or ‘friend’ as ‘frend’

Such errors are not due to poor teaching or environment alone, but arise from difficulties in processing written language.

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SOLUTIONS AND CORRECTIVE MEASURES:

1. Multisensory teaching.
2. Oral answering.
3. Reading and writing.
4. Work on correct pronunciation.
5. Use of audio visuals.
6. Use of ICT.

2. Dysgraphia

Dysgraphia refers to the disorder where some people have trouble writing or expressing their thoughts. Poor handwriting is the main feature of dysgraphia, but it is not the only symptom. Afflicted individuals struggle to put their thoughts into writing and are unable to do critical thinking and struggle with their memory. Individuals with dysgraphia may experience difficulty with letter spacing, poor motor planning, spatial awareness, and trouble thinking and writing simultaneously.

Examples of dysgraphia include:

- Writing letters or numbers in reverse, e.g., writing “b” for “d” or “31” for “13.”
- Inconsistent spacing between letters/words: e.g., writing “t h e c a t” instead of “the cat.”
- Mixing uppercase and lowercase letters within a word, e.g., “DoG” or “houSe.”
- Spelling the same word differently in the same paragraph, e.g., “frend,” “freind,” “friend.”
- Difficulty keeping writing aligned on the page, words floating above/below the line.

SOLUTIONS AND CORRECTIVE MEASURES:

1. Writing in sand.
2. Air writing.



3. Dot tracing.
4. Correct pencil grip.
5. Writing practice.

3. Dyscalculia

Dyscalculia refers to the learning disabilities related to mathematical calculations. Individuals with dyscalculia struggle with mathematical concepts, numbers, and logic. Sometimes referred to as “math dyslexia.” Such children make many mistakes such as mistaking 6 for 9, mistaking 3 for 8 and in addition and subtraction -

An example of addition, as done by a student who has dyscalculia, is given hereby:

$$\begin{array}{r} 15 \\ + 17 \\ \hline 212 \end{array}$$

SOLUTIONS AND CORRECTIVE MEASURES:

1. Hands-on experience.
2. Visual tools.
3. Step by step instruction to build number understanding.
4. Give them real life experience through shopping activities.
5. Use of number blocks, flashcards, chart papers.
6. Counting snacks, beads, stones.
7. Handling money.
8. Field trips.

4. Dyspraxia:

Developmental coordination disorder is known as Dyspraxia. It is a neuro-developmental condition that begins in childhood that makes it difficult to perform motor skills. It also causes problems with coordination. Although there is no cure, occupational therapy can greatly help children with dyspraxia learn

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how to cope with these challenges.

SOLUTIONS AND CORRECTIVE MEASURES:

1. Needle- thread activity.
2. Catch and throw the ball.
3. Bead threading.
4. Cutting and folding shapes.
5. Playing with clay.
6. Building blocks.

5. Developmental Aphasia:

Developmental aphasia is a disorder that results from damage to the parts of the brain that are responsible for comprehending language. These areas are situated on the left side of the brain. Aphasia usually occurs suddenly but can accompany a stroke or head injury also. It can also develop gradually, as a result of brain tumor or progressive neurological disease. This disorder impairs expression of language and understanding, reading and writing. Aphasia may occur alongside speech disorders, such as dysarthria or apraxia of speech, which also result from brain damage.

SOLUTIONS AND CORRECTIVE MEASURES:

1. Use simple, clear language.
2. Repeat and rephrase.
3. Speak slowly.
4. Use pictures, signs, gestures.
5. Mimicry, cartoon dialogues, cartoon theme songs.
6. Storytelling.

8.4.3 Causes of Learning Disability

Several causes of learning disability are as under:

1. Pre- Natal:

- Early marriage.
- Mother not getting enough nutrition during pregnancy.
- Mother using alcohol and drugs during pregnancy.
- Using medicines during pregnancy without consulting a doctor.

2. Natal:

- Childbirth (delivery) by untrained people.
- Low birth weight of the baby.
- Forcing the baby out during delivery.
- Lack of oxygen in the baby at birth.

3. Post Natal:

- Due to any serious illness or accident.
- Not giving proper vaccination.
- Malnutrition.

8.4.4 Screening and Identification of Children with Learning Disability**Early identification and intervention**

According to the New Education Policy (NEP) 2020, over 85% of a child's brain development occurs by the age of six. The policy emphasises the critical importance of providing appropriate care and stimulation during these early years to support healthy brain development and growth. Therefore, it is of utmost importance that every child has access to quality Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE).

The goal of ECCE, as outlined in NEP 2020, is to achieve optimal outcomes in various domains, including physical and motor development, cognitive development, social, cultural, and artistic development, as well as the development of communication, early language, literacy, and numeracy skills.

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The aims of ECCE under NEP 2020 align closely with the goals of early identification and intervention.

In the context of disabilities in the classroom, early identification and intervention refer to the process through which parents, educators, health professionals, or any concerned adult can recognize developmental milestones in children and understand the value of identifying concerns at an early stage. This timely recognition allows for appropriate support and intervention to be provided, ensuring the best possible outcomes for the child.

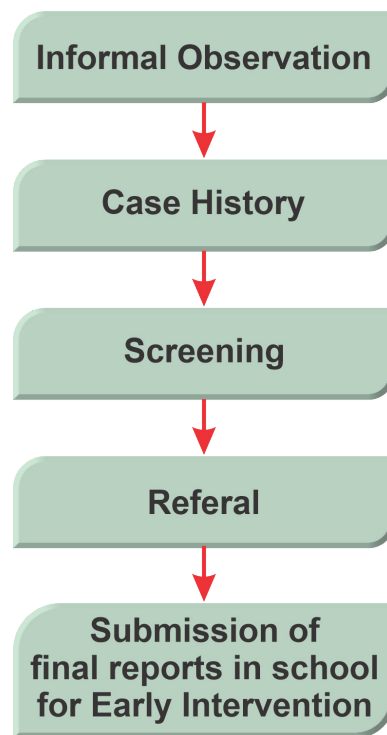
Early Identification of CWSN:

Fig. 8.1: Steps for early identification of CWSNs

Note: Use above steps to identify CWSN studying in schools. PRASHAST (Pre-Assessment, Holistic Screening Tool) app may also be used for the purpose, which is a digital tool developed by NCERT.

The Process of Early Identification

The process of early identification starts with the first step of informal observation and proceed towards the proper and final diagnosis-

Table 8.4: Process of Early Identification of CWSN

Sr. No.	Name of the steps	Process
1.	Informal Observation	During this type of observation, a teacher informally observes children in curricular and co-curricular activities to understand the normal and divided pattern. If there is a problem, it should be reported to a special educator or Educational and Vocational Guidance Counsellor (EVGC). Also, the teacher can proceed to discuss the issue with parents while the Special Educator can take case history.
2.	Case History	Special Education Teacher and class teacher/ subject teacher will discuss issues in very sensitive manner with child's parents and case history will be undertaken by special education teacher to know about the onset of problems, development and milestone educational history, family history and past referral reports etc. After taking case history, special education teacher, class teacher, subject teacher will decide whether there is a need for screening or not.
3.	Screening	After taking case history, if Special Education Teacher feels the need for a formal process of screening the child, he/she may proceed by taking class teacher/ subject teacher in the loop. If screening indicates any other problematic issue besides the case history, he/she should be referred to respective professionals and hospitals for a formal assessment and diagnosis.
4.	Referral	Special Education Teacher can give a recommendation letter to the parent on school letter head and refer the child with difficulty to a specialist of respective field or the child may be taken to the assessment camp organized by Govt. hospitals and other agencies.

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5.	Submission of final report in school for early intervention	After getting a proper diagnostic report and certificate, parents should submit the copies of reports and certificates to the Special Education Teacher or their class teacher. This will help in making the teacher aware of the child's condition and do holistic planning as soon as possible.
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Checklist of Screening and Identification of Specific Learning Disability (SLD):

Note: If the child has IQ above 85, yet shows below listed characteristics, it indicates presence of an SLD. If IQ report is not available, look for the underlined characteristics:

1. Does the child have difficulty in maintaining attention while performing a given task without getting distracted when unsupervised?
2. Does the child have difficulty in completing the task within the prescribed time-limit when unsupervised?
3. Does the child commit pattern of consistent errors as listed below:
 - a) Skips letters or words while reading a line from a text.
 - b) Has difficulty tracking lines or words in a row and hence uses fingers for tracking while reading.
 - c) Has difficulty in organizing things. For example, unable to organise things as per their shape, colour or size such as placing books in a school bag systematically by size or arranging clothes on a rack in categories of size and use.
 - d) Difficulty in comprehending from black board without missing letters or words.
 - e) Difficulty in using mathematical symbols and understanding relation between numbers.
 - f) Difficulty in differentiating letters such as 'b', 'd', or numbers like '9' and '6'.
 - g) Difficulty in maintaining a straight line or leaving appropriate space between words.

- j) Difficulty in the use of punctuation while reading or writing.
- i) Difficulty in comprehending word problems, understanding the meaning and relationship between numbers and sentences.

8.4.5 Different Strategies for Early Intervention of Children with Learning Disability

Early intervention services are a range of specific services that are intended to help young children with special needs who have developmental delays. Different types of specialists work with these children giving them specialized support. This support might include special educators, therapists, counselors etc.

Parents and teachers should immediately consult a doctor or professional if they observe that their child is not doing all the tasks on time like other children. Intensive intervention is the most effective type of cure for children with disabilities (CWSN). It's not just about the number of hours; it's also about the quality of those hours and how the therapy helps the child. Parents and teachers are usually the first interventionists for infants and young children with developmental delays. Different children respond differently to intervention, so no single program will be suitable for all children and their families. Interventions are tailored to the child's needs. Many children with disabilities can be benefitted from some type of early intervention or therapy.

For example:

- Children who need occupational therapy can be helped with their fine motor skills, self-help skills like playing, dressing and toilet training.
- Children who have motor difficulties like walking, balancing, sitting, crawling and walking should go to a good physiotherapist so that they can learn the related skills on time and make their lives better.
- Some children often have speech related difficulties like stuttering, stammering, etc. They should be taken to speech therapy as early as possible so that the child can master the language by learning those skills on time.

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Table 8.5: Different Strategies at Foundational and Preparatory Stage

Levels	Focus on the curriculum	Teaching strategies & activities	Teaching learning materials	Evaluation
Foundational Stage	• Mother tongue to serve as medium of socialization to make them feel at home in the new atmosphere of school. • Language will help a child's mental, moral and emotional development. Emphasis should be given more on oral expression.	• No formal method of reading and writing methods/ activities to be adopted • Story telling • Free conversation with every child encourages participation of all children. • Recitation of rhymes. • Singing songs • Picture reading • Puppet plays • Dramatisation and role play • Playing word games • Practicing pronunciation to aid children with speech difficulty Providing ample opportunities to speak in class, assembly etc.	• Picture book • Scrapbook Made of cutting from old magazines, pictures, posters, greeting cards etc. • Models of animals, fruits, flowers, vegetables etc. • Letter/ picture/ models blocks made from cardboard, wood, paper machine • CD/cassette for song rhymes • Animation films • Puppets	• Mainly through observation of free expression & participation of all children; storytelling, sharing of experiences.

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Levels	Focus on the curriculum	Teaching strategies & Activities	Teaching learning materials	Evaluation
Preparatory stage	• Basic skills of listening and speaking in mother tongue and use it for day-to-day communication needs. • The focus of classes I & II would be to acquire the basic skill of reading and writing in his mother tongue/ regional language/ gradually to other languages. • Emphasis should be given more on oral expression.	• Attention should be paid on improvement of punctuation according to standard usage in the mother tongue through loud reading and/ or speaking with proper voice modulation. • To develop the skill of good writing and correct spelling through practice. • To develop a habit of silent reading with comprehension. • To develop child's ability for creative self-expression through story making, picture reading about oneself and/or any person (relative), incident, event etc. • Open communication with teachers and sharing own experiences with others.	• Story Books • Games (scrabble) scrap books • Word books • Bank specially made up with tactile alphabets made of cardboard strips pictures embossed vocabulary • Name plates/ word cards made up of cardboard strips, pictures embossed vocabulary. • Box: A cardboard box with 20-25 small objects of daily use to teach nouns; preposition, concept of colors, shapes etc. • VCD and audio • CD cassettes.	• Reading test • Dictation for checking spelling and handwriting. • Asking questions while reading for checking comprehension • Story making • Observation • Identification

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8.5 INDIVIDUALISED EDUCATION PLAN (IEP)**8.5.1 Concept of Individualised Education plan (IEP)**

The concept of Individualised Education Plan (IEPs) in India has roots in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, with the establishment of schools for children with disabilities, particularly the visually and hearing impaired. While not explicitly labeled as IEPs, these early institutions focused on individualised instruction and assessment to meet the unique needs of students. The post-independence period saw a growth in special education centers, and the concept of IEPs began to emerge more formally.

As per the provisions of Section 16 (vii) of the RPWD Act, 2016, it is the responsibility of every Govt. establishment to monitor participation, progress in terms of attainment levels and completion of education in respect of every CWSN.

Individualised Education Plan (IEP) is to provide a plan to help a student meet individual outcomes or goals beyond his or her current skills. For this reason, an understanding of what a student can and cannot do is essential to the individual education planning process. Each IEP is individual to the student for whom it is designed. IEP is revised at least twice a year or depending on the goals achieved by the child. It is done after evaluation of the progress of the child so that modification in the current program may be made or new goals may be set accordingly.

8.5.2 How to prepare Individualized Education Plan

When a CWSN enrolled in your school, first as a teacher, you should welcome him/her, introduce him/her to other children, school environment, teachers and other staff. Next is to meet his/her parents and take case history. On this basis, you can make a monthly plan according to his/her needs. This individual education plan has three main parts which are as follows -

Part A: This will have basic information about the child. This is to be filled only while revising the IEP i.e. twice or thrice in an academic year. Annual goals shall be set at the start of the academic year in consultation with parents of CWSN and concerned subject teachers. These goals should be in sync with the last year's achievement of the child. Short term goals will be revised after evaluation of previous IEP.

Part B: This will cover co-curricular activities, Activities of Daily Living (ADL), therapeutic needs such as occupational therapy and speech and language therapy, pre-vocational and vocational training, motor skill development, life skills, etc. Part B will be prepared in collaboration and consultation with the relevant subject teachers and specialists in the school. It will be filled for each short-term goal selected. For example, if three different short-term goals are selected for a student, Part B forms are to be filled separately for these three goals.

Part C: It will cover the academics of the child. It will be prepared in discussion with subject teachers. It should be planned, implemented and evaluated monthly.

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INDIVIDUALISED EDUCATION PLAN

PART- A

Session 2020-2021/2025-26

- | | |
|--------------------------|----------------------------|
| Name of Student with ID: | Date of Birth: |
| Father's/ Mother's Name: | Gender: |
| School Name and ID: | Class and Section: |
| Address and Contact no.: | Date of filling up of IEP: |
1. Type of Special Need:
 2. Degree of Disability (as mentioned in disability certificate):
 3. Associated Conditions, if any:
 4. Mother Tongue/ Languages Spoken by the Student:
 5. Any other Significant Information about the Student: (Medical condition/ Achievements/Interest areas/Adaptation needed/Any other)
 6. Special Education and Related Services:
 7. CBSE Relaxations:
 8. Annual Goals:
 9. Short Term Goals:

Signature of SET

Signature and Stamp of HOS

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INDIVIDUALISED EDUCATION PLAN

PART B

IEP No.:

Date of Planning:

Name of SET:

Date of Evaluation:

1. Area/ Domain:
2. Task/ Skill/ Activity:
3. Present Functioning Level/Current Functioning Level/ Baseline:
4. Specific Objective/ Behavioural Objective:
5. Setting in which Objectives to be Implemented: Inclusive Classroom/
Resource Room/Any other (Specify)
6. TLM to be Used:
7. Teaching Strategies to be Used:
8. Teaching Procedure:
9. Adaptations/Accommodations/Modifications: (In line with CBSE
Relaxations and Guidelines)
10. Evaluation:

Signature of SET

Signature and Stamp of HOS

INDIVIDUALISED EDUCATION PLAN

Part - C

Name of CWSN:

Class & Section:

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Notes

Subject & Subject Teacher's Name	Topics for Remediation	Adaptations (Accommodations/ Modifications)	Teaching Strategies and Resources	TLM to be used	Evaluation

(Source: Directorate of Education GNCT Delhi)

8.5.3 Challenges Faced by Teachers During Teaching-Learning Process and Possible Suggestions for Addressing

When Teachers prepare IEPs (Individualised Education Plan) for students with disabilities, teachers face many problems like insufficient training, lack of resources, communication issues, and difficulty balancing diverse needs of learners. Some challenges faced by teachers while preparing IEP Plan for CWSN are given in the following manner:

1. Diverse Learning Styles:

Today we see in all our classrooms that there are children with different learning abilities which also include differently abled children. The teachers must teach all children by adjusting their teaching plan as per the needs of the disabled child and teachers should adapt their teaching methods to accommodate visual, auditory, kinesthetic and other learning preferences.

2. Classroom Management:

When different types of children are studying in classroom which includes a teacher should first organize his/her classroom according to the needs every child. Teachers may face these challenges in this task:

- Limited teaching -learning resources.

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- Already over burden of the teachers.
- Insufficient training on the preparation of IEP.
- Teacher's attitude/reluctance.
- Curriculum adaptation.
- Lack of parental support in teaching-learning process.

Some suggestions for teachers preparing IEP:

- Usage of UDL and Differentiated Instruction during classroom teaching.
- Explore about diverse learning needs and prepare a plan accordingly.
- The Government should organize Professional Development Programs for the teachers.
- Adequate usage of technology.
- Preparation of classroom management strategies.
- Proper utilization of resources available in the school.
- In teaching learning process, teachers should motivate parents of CWSN.
- All staff and teachers will play a collaborative role in school.
- More engagement of students with disability and without disability.

8.6 DIFFERENTIATED LEARNING**8.6.1 Meaning & Concept of Differentiated Learning**

Due to India's immense diversity, students from different cultures, socio-economic status, languages, genders, abilities, disabilities, learning styles, personal interests are part of school. Teachers must be aware of these diversities. When they plan to teach these children, their diversity should not become a hindrance in their learning. Teachers can develop individualised instruction by considering the learning needs of children so that all these children can learn effectively. The new education policy (NEP-2020) strongly supports that teachers should use different teaching methods and strategies according to the diversity of children, in which universal design for learning and differentiated instruction are important. Here we will talk about differentiated instruction or learning.



Notes

Differentiated instruction is also known as differentiated learning. In this type of teaching, the teacher creates a framework for effective learning opportunities by understanding differentiation according to the needs of the children. This includes providing all students within their diverse classroom community of learners a variety of ways to understand new information (often in the same class) to acquire content, process ideas, create or understand; and developing assessment measures to know the impact of the teaching material so that all students within the class can learn effectively despite differences in their ability.

Differentiated instruction means using different tools, materials and appropriate procedures to successfully facilitate all individuals. Differentiated instruction, or differentiation can occur at two different levels - the administrative level and the classroom level. The administrative level takes into account the socio-economic status and gender of students. At the classroom level, differentiation revolves around content, processing, product, and effects. We can learn this through a chart.

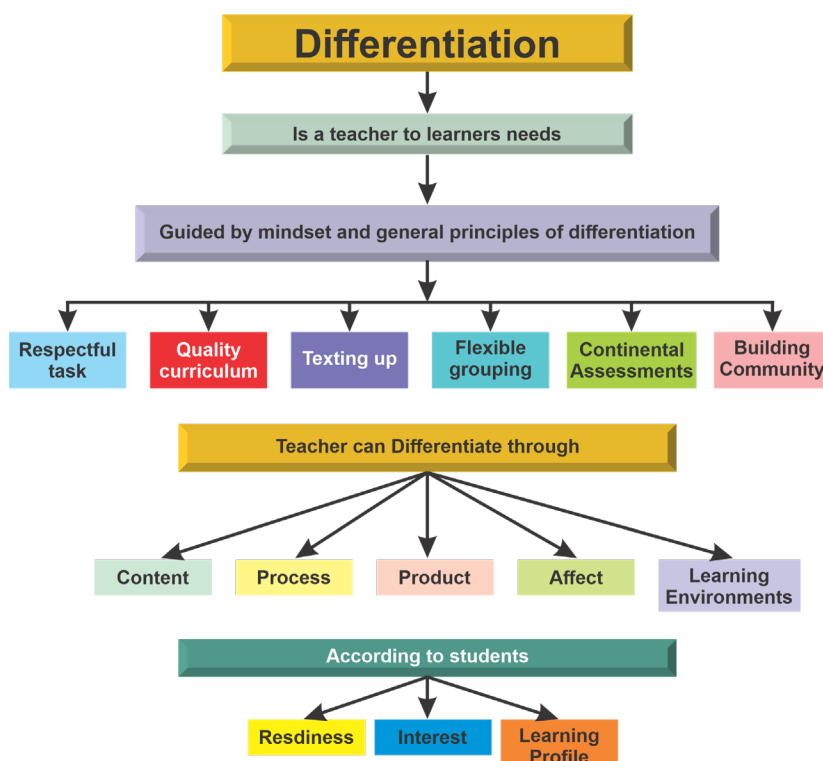


Fig. 8.2: Differentiated Learning revolving around Content, Processing, Product, and Effects

Inclusive Classrooms



Notes

8.6.2 Need and Significance of Differentiated Learning

Differentiated learning plays a vital role in education because it recognizes the diverse learning needs and learning styles of students, tailoring instruction to maximise individual growth and success. This approach enhances classroom engagement, improves academic achievement, and fosters a more inclusive learning environment in the school premises.

Differentiated instruction addresses each student's own special needs, interests, and strengths, giving them the opportunity to learn according to their needs and develop themselves holistically. It may help in :

- Increasing classroom engagement.
- Improving student academic outcomes.
- Promoting a healthy, positive and supportive learning environment
- Addressing diverse needs and different learning styles.
- Promoting active learning.
- Closing the achievement gap of students.
- Increasing teacher effectiveness.

8.6.3 How to Use Differentiated Learning in Teaching-Learning Process

1. Recital Method {both by students and teacher}
2. Role Play
3. Smartboards
4. Small Group Learning, Peer Learning and Discussions
5. Use of TLM
6. Games and Activities
7. Multisensory Approach
8. Peer Tutoring
9. Art & Crafts
10. Individual Attention

8.7 LET US SUM UP

In this chapter, we learned how to make a classroom more inclusive and effective for diverse learners, keeping in mind different disabilities and problems faced in classrooms. The chapter includes corrective measures for prominent disabilities seen in students. We discussed Individualised Education Plan and Differentiated Learning and the strategies and techniques to inculcate them among students.

**8.8 END EXERCISES**

1. In your experience, what challenges did you face to make your classroom an inclusive classroom?
2. What strategies will you use to teach diverse learners?
3. What are your thoughts on Differentiated Learning?
4. Differentiate between Segregation, Integration and Inclusion.
5. What factors to keep in mind while assessing a CwDs?
6. Discuss the process of screening and identification of students with special needs.
7. What are the characteristics observed in learning disabled students?
8. What do you understand by Dyslexia, Dysgraphia and Dyscalculia?
9. Discuss the corrective measures taken for problems like Dyslexia, Dysgraphia and Dyscalculia.
10. How will you make your classroom inclusive?

Inclusive Classrooms*Notes*

Inclusive Classrooms



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8.9 REFERENCES

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